

Ph.D. in Computer Science | Human-AI Interaction Researcher

Research scientist with expertise in human-AI interaction, machine learning, and computer graphics. Published 15+ peer-reviewed papers (310+ citations, h-index 9, top paper: 112 citations at CHI '23) including Best Paper Award at ACM VRST and Honorable Mention at ACM MuC. Led research on human-in-the-loop optimization systems, combining empirical user studies with computational methods. Experienced in teaching (12 courses) and thesis supervision (20+ students). See [Research Portfolio](#).

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Media Informatics (Dr. rer. nat.)

LMU Munich

Feb. 2019 – Apr. 2023

Munich, Germany

- **Thesis:** *"The Intelligence in the Loop: Empirical Explorations and Reflections"*, Magna cum Laude
- **Thesis Committee:** Prof. Dr.-Ing. [Andreas Butz](#) (Erstberichterstatter), Prof. Dr. [Eyke Hüllermeier](#) (Zweitberichterstatter), Prof. Dr.-Ing. [Marc Stamminger](#) (Drittberichterstatter).

Master Student Human-Computer Interaction (M.Sc.)

LMU Munich; overall grade: 1.63 (max. 1.0) "Very Good"

Oct. 2016 – Jan. 2019

Munich, Germany

- **Thesis:** *"Understanding and Predicting Web Browsing Behavior"*
- **Advisors:** Dr. [Daniel Buschek](#), Dr. [Malin Eiband](#), Prof. Dr. [Heinrich Hußmann](#)

Bachelor Student Computer Science and Engineering (B.Eng.)

Southwest University for Nationalities; overall grade: 3.74 (max. 4.0), ranked 1st of 154 students

Sep. 2012 – Jul. 2016

Chengdu, China

- **Thesis:** *"Designing Alternative Contact-free Control Modalities for Smart Watches"*
- **Advisor:** Prof. Dr. [Yaxi Chen](#)

RECENT PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer (promoted from Software Engineer)

[Sixt SE](#)

Sep. 2022 – Present

Munich Pullach, Germany

- **AI transformation:** Leading organization-wide AI transformation in direct partnership with executive and C-level stakeholders; drove 7k+ users to active AI usage and native agentic workflows.
- **AI infrastructure:** Established self-hosted, self-controlled full-stack AI engineering infrastructure with embedded security and governance across compute, model, harness, and application layers: compute sandbox, LLM gateway, chat agents, document intelligence, and more.
- **Revenue optimization:** Designed and built AI-driven revenue optimization solutions; drove 2.5% margin uplift and made yield systems 300x faster for 10x business scale.
- **Customer service:** Integrated LLM-powered, knowledge-centric systems to accelerate customer-service transformation for the Sixt SE POS.

Research Associate, Lecturer

LMU Munich

Apr. 2018 – Mar. 2023, Apr. 2024 – Present

Munich, Germany

- **As lecturer:** Supervised 18 students in conducting scientific research
- **As researcher:** Researched human-in-the-loop machine learning for 3D graphics systems
- **As teacher:** Taught 12 classes (as lecturer/instructor/assistant/tutor) and supervised 20+ student theses and seminars
- **As developer:** Developed a 3D mesh processing backend system in collaboration with industry partner [WAY digital solutions](#); developed, migrated, and maintained a 17-year-old [university CMS system](#) and a 13-year-old [collaborative system](#)

PUBLICATIONS

- F. Chiossi, L. Haliburton, **C. Ou**, et al. 2023. *Short-Form Videos Degrade Our Capacity to Retain Intentions*. ACM CHI '23. (112 citations)
- D. Dietz, ..., **C. Ou**, et al. 2022. *Walk This Beam: Balance Assistance in VR*. ACM VRST '22. 🏆 **Best Paper**. (24 citations)
- **C. Ou**, et al. 2022. *The Human in the Infinite Loop: Human-AI Interaction Loop Failures*. ACM MuC '22. 🏆 **Honorable Mention**. (15 citations)

- **C. Ou**, S. Mayer, A. Butz. 2023. *The Impact of Expertise in the Loop for Exploring Machine Rationality*. ACM IUI '23. (12 citations)
- **C. Ou**. 2024. *The Intelligence in the Loop: Empirical Explorations and Reflections*. Ph.D. Dissertation, LMU Munich.

Full list: changkun.de/research (15+ papers, 310+ citations, h-index 9).

See [my research page](#) or [Google Scholar](#) for more details.

EXPERTISE AND SKILLS

- **Domain:** *AI deployment and agent platforms*; *LLM gateways, evals, sandbox runtimes, OAuth/OIDC, Kubernetes*; *Machine learning* (PyTorch/sklearn/TensorFlow/etc.); *Data analysis* (numpy/seaborn/pandas/etc.); *Computer graphics* (3D rendering and geometry processing, Blender/OpenGL/Metal/three.js); *Web development* (Go/React/etc.).
- **Language:** *Go* (9+ years); *Python* (7+ years); *LaTeX* (10+ years); *C/C++* (5+ years); *JavaScript/TypeScript* (5+ years); I speak native Mandarin; fluent professional English; elementary German.

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

ACM SIGCHI Gary Marsden Travel Awards <i>Full Travel Support</i>	Jan. 2023
ACM Symposium on Virtual Reality Software and Technology <i>Best Paper Award</i>	Nov. 2022
ACM SIGCHI Mensch und Computer <i>Honorable Mention Award</i>	Sep. 2022
China National Scholarship <i>University of Electronic Science and Technology of China</i>	Sep. 2016 <i>Chengdu, China</i>
China National Scholarship <i>Southwest University for Nationalities</i>	Sep. 2014 <i>Chengdu, China</i>
Meritorious Winner in Mathematical Contest in Modeling (MCM) <i>Top 9% internationally</i>	Apr. 2014

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Associate Chair <i>ACM CHI, IFIP INTERACT</i>	CHI '24-'26, INTERACT '25
Reviewer	CHI '20-'25, MobileHCI '23, ICMI '22-'23, IMWUT '22, INTERACT '21

TEACHING

Taught 12 courses at LMU Munich (Computer Graphics, Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Geometry Processing). Supervised 20+ theses.